Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Movable major and minor barre-chord families, root finding, partial barres, and pressure management

11 MODULES | 996 ATTACKS | 56 SILENT LANDINGS

Level 50 made open-chord transitions efficient. Level 51 removes the nut from the shape and turns the open E and A families into movable major and minor chords. The technical goal is clean tone with the least necessary pressure; the musical goal is finding any root and choosing the correct family quickly.

1. Find the root

Low-E roots control E-shape chords. A-string roots control A-shape chords. Name the note before forming the grip.

2. Build from partial to full

Begin with two- and three-string barres, then add chord fingers. Full six-string pressure is the final step, not the starting point.

3. Release between efforts

A barre chord is not a continuous squeeze. Press for the sound, release when silent, and rest before fatigue becomes pain.

Four movable families

```
E-SHAPE MAJOR   R 5 R 3 5 R    frets r r+2 r+2 r+1 r r
E-SHAPE MINOR   R 5 R b3 5 R   frets r r+2 r+2 r   r r
A-SHAPE MAJOR   x R 5 R 3 5    frets x r r+2 r+2 r+2 r
A-SHAPE MINOR   x R 5 R b3 5   frets x r r+2 r+2 r+1 r

PARTIAL OPTIONS
E upper four:   x x R 3/b3 5 R
A inner four:   x R 5 R 3/b3 x

r = root fret; x = intentionally muted string.
```

Written workload

Module	Attacks
A - silent roots	56 silent
B - barre scans	40
C - E families	168
D - A families	140
E - quality switches	112
F - same-fret pairs	96
G - root ladders	56
H - same-shape routes	64
I - mixed progressions	128
J - partial comping	64
K - capstones	128
SOUNDED TOTAL	996

Physical boundary

Start near frets 5-7, where the fret spacing and string tension are manageable. Add the fret-1 F chord last. Rest after every four full-barre cells. Stop for pain, numbness, tingling, or a hand position that cannot relax after release.

PRESSURE RULE Move the index placement before increasing whole-hand pressure.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Root maps and silent chord-formation calls

MODULE A | 56 SILENT LANDINGS

LOW E STRING = E-SHAPE ROOTS | A STRING = A-SHAPE ROOTS

Chromatic root map, frets 1-12

Fret	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Low E	F	F#/Gb	G	G#/Ab	A	Bb	B	C	C#/Db	D	Eb	E
A string	Bb	B	C	C#/Db	D	Eb	E	F	F#/Gb	G	G#/Ab	A

Natural-note E-shape calls

```
Root | F  G  A  B  C  D  E
Fret | 1  3  5  7  8 10 12
Call | F/Fm  G/Gm  A/Am  B/Bm  C/Cm  D/Dm  E/Em
```

For every root-quality call: form one full chord silently, release, then form the upper-four partial silently. Inspect the attack zone without strumming.

Natural-note A-shape calls

```
Root | B  C  D  E  F  G  A
Fret | 2  3  5  7  8 10 12
Call | B/Bm  C/Cm  D/Dm  E/Em  F/Fm  G/Gm  A/Am
```

For every root-quality call: form one full chord silently, release, then form the inner-four partial silently. Keep the low E muted.

Random-root extension

Write the twelve chromatic root names on cards. Draw one card, choose E-shape or A-shape, and announce major or minor before touching the neck. Accidentals are an extension after the natural-root calls are automatic.

PASS The correct root fret and quality are formed within four silent counts, with no strum and no fret-by-fret search.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Barre pressure, index placement, and release mechanics

MINIMUM PRESSURE | NO DEATH GRIP

MOVE THE INDEX AND ARM BEFORE ADDING MORE THUMB PRESSURE

1. Place near the fret

The index lies just behind the fret wire. Roll slightly toward its thumb-side edge. Avoid placing the soft center of every joint directly over a string.

2. Add arm support

Let the fretting arm draw the neck lightly toward the body while the picking arm stabilizes the guitar. The thumb guides; it does not crush.

3. Solve one dead string

Pick the failed string alone. Shift index angle or vertical position by a few millimeters. Do not respond by squeezing every finger harder.

Pressure-fade cell

```
Count|1--------2--------3--------4--------|
Hand |PRESS----FADE-----BUZZ-----RESTORE--|
Pick |one string on every count            |
Goal |restore only the pressure needed     |
```

Use fret 5 first. Repeat on B and high e, then test the remaining strings.

Press-release pulse

```
Count|1----2----3----4----|1----2----3----4----|
Hand |P----R----P----R----|P----R----P----R----|
Sound|ring mute ring mute |ring mute ring mute |
```

R means release pressure while keeping the index in contact. The thumb also relaxes.

Stop conditions

Normal effort can feel unfamiliar, but sharp pain, tingling, numbness, burning, or lingering hand tension is a stop signal. Shake out the hand, shorten the chord, move higher on the neck, or end the session.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module B - partial-barre ladder and clean-string scans

FRETS 5 AND 7 | 40 ATTACKS

BUILD TWO STRINGS, THEN THREE, FOUR, FIVE, AND SIX

Stage	Active strings	Fret-5 notes	Attacks
2-string barre	B + high e	5 5	2 attacks
3-string barre	G + B + high e	5 5 5	3 attacks
4-string barre	D + G + B + high e	5 5 5 5	4 attacks
5-string barre	A through high e	5 5 5 5 5	5 attacks
6-string barre	low E through high e	5 5 5 5 5 5	6 attacks

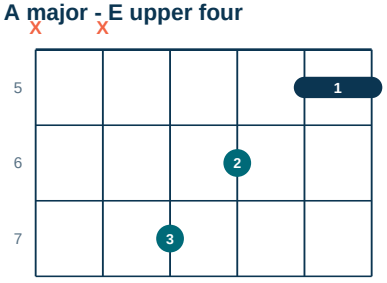
Fret-5 pass

Pick every active string from low to high. Release completely between stages. Total: 2+3+4+5+6 = 20 attacks.

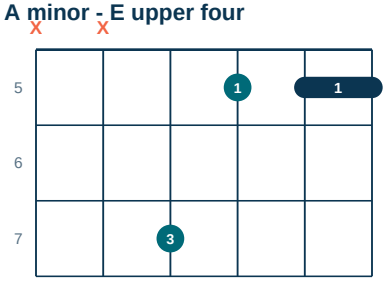
Fret-7 pass

Repeat the same ladder at fret 7. If fret 7 is cleaner than fret 5, the problem is likely pressure or placement rather than strength.

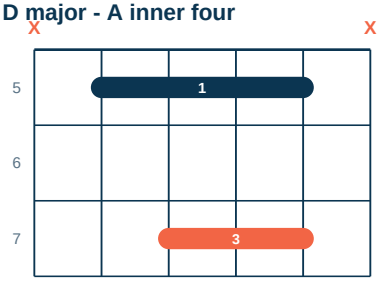
A major - E upper four



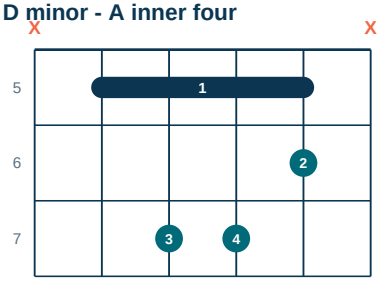
A minor - E upper four



D major - A inner four



D minor - A inner four



Movable E-shape and A-shape major/minor barre chords. Use minimal pressure; stop for pain, numbness, or tingling.

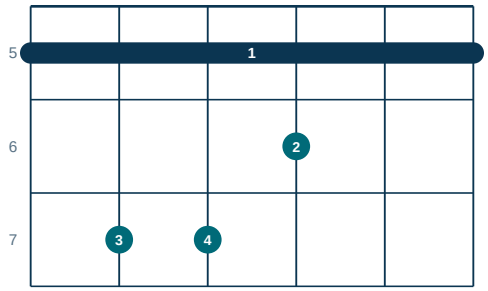
Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module C - movable E-shape major family

7 NATURAL ROOTS | 84 ATTACKS

ROOT ON LOW E; ATTACK ALL SIX STRINGS

A major reference - 577655



Shape formula and string roles

```
String | E    A    D    G    B    e
Role   | R    5    R    3    5    R
Fret   | r    r+2  r+2  r+1  r    r
Finger | 1    3    4    2    1    1
```

Construction order: chord fingers -> index barre -> thumb support -> scan.

Chord	Root fret	Frets E A D G B e	Spelling	Comfort order
F	1	1 3 3 2 1 1	F A C	LAST
G	3	3 5 5 4 3 3	G B D	2
A	5	5 7 7 6 5 5	A C# E	1
B	7	7 9 9 8 7 7	B D# F#	6
C	8	8 10 10 9 8 8	C E G	3
D	10	10 12 12 11 10 10	D F# A	4
E	12	12 14 14 13 12 12	E G# B	5

SCAN For each chord: pick low-to-high, then high-to-low. 12 attacks per chord. Rest after every four chords.

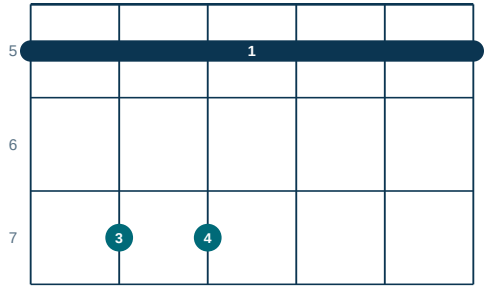
Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module C - movable E-shape minor family

7 NATURAL ROOTS | 84 ATTACKS

LIFT THE MAJOR-THIRD FINGER; THE INDEX NOW FRETS THE G-STRING b3

A minor reference - 577555



Shape formula and string roles

```
String | E    A    D    G    B    e
Role   | R    5    R    b3   5    R
Fret   | r    r+2  r+2  r    r    r
Finger | 1    3    4    1    1    1
```

The G string is part of the index barre. Do not let the ring finger touch it.

Chord	Root fret	Frets E A D G B e	Spelling	Comfort order
Fm	1	1 3 3 1 1 1	F Ab C	LAST
Gm	3	3 5 5 3 3 3	G Bb D	2
Am	5	5 7 7 5 5 5	A C E	1
Bm	7	7 9 9 7 7 7	B D F#	6
Cm	8	8 10 10 8 8 8	C Eb G	3
Dm	10	10 12 12 10 10 10	D F A	4
Em	12	12 14 14 12 12 12	E G B	5

AUDIT If G string is dead, move the index or ring finger. Do not add pressure to the entire grip.

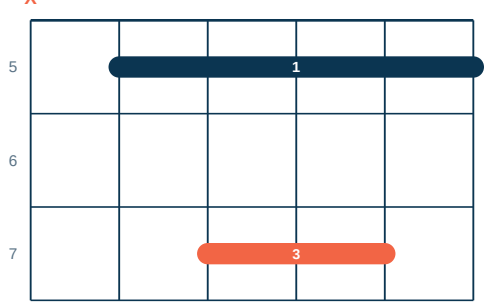
Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module D - movable A-shape major family

7 NATURAL ROOTS | 70 ATTACKS

ROOT ON A STRING; MUTE LOW E; KEEP HIGH E CLEAR IN THE FULL VERSION

D major reference - x57775



Full and partial versions

```
FULL     x r r+2 r+2 r+2 r     roles x R 5 R 3 5
PARTIAL  x r r+2 r+2 r+2 x     roles x R 5 R 3 x

Finger 1 barres A through high e. Finger 3 mini-barres D-G-B.
For the partial version, the ring finger may lightly mute high e.
For the full version, roll the ring finger so high e remains clear.
```

Chord	Root fret	Full frets	Partial frets	Spelling
B	2	x 2 4 4 4 2	x 2 4 4 4 x	B D# F#
C	3	x 3 5 5 5 3	x 3 5 5 5 x	C E G
D	5	x 5 7 7 7 5	x 5 7 7 7 x	D F# A
E	7	x 7 9 9 9 7	x 7 9 9 9 x	E G# B
F	8	x 8 10 10 10 8	x 8 10 10 10 x	F A C
G	10	x 10 12 12 12 10	x 10 12 12 12 x	G B D
A	12	x 12 14 14 14 12	x 12 14 14 14 x	A C# E

SCAN Pick A-D-G-B-e, then e-B-G-D-A. 10 attacks per chord. Low E remains muted.

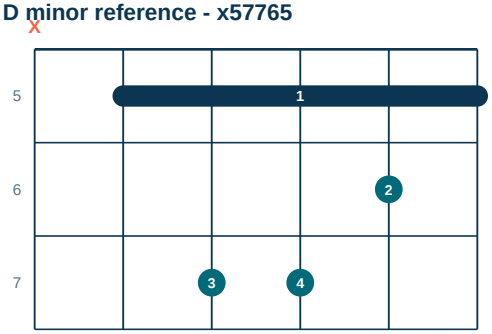
Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module D - movable A-shape minor family

7 NATURAL ROOTS | 70 ATTACKS

THE B-STRING NOTE MOVES DOWN ONE FRET TO CREATE b3

D minor reference - x57765



Shape formula and string roles

```
FULL     x r r+2 r+2 r+1 r     roles x R 5 R b3 5
PARTIAL  x r r+2 r+2 r+1 x     roles x R 5 R b3 x

Finger 1 barres A through high e. Ring frets D, pinky frets G, middle frets B.
Build the three chord fingers first; add only enough index pressure to sound A and high e.
```

Chord	Root fret	Full frets	Partial frets	Spelling
Bm	2	x 2 4 4 3 2	x 2 4 4 3 x	B D F#
Cm	3	x 3 5 5 4 3	x 3 5 5 4 x	C Eb G
Dm	5	x 5 7 7 6 5	x 5 7 7 6 x	D F A
Em	7	x 7 9 9 8 7	x 7 9 9 8 x	E G B
Fm	8	x 8 10 10 9 8	x 8 10 10 9 x	F Ab C
Gm	10	x 10 12 12 11 10	x 10 12 12 11 x	G Bb D
Am	12	x 12 14 14 13 12	x 12 14 14 13 x	A C E

RELEASE After the scan, release the index and thumb completely before moving to the next root.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module E - E-shape major/minor quality switches

7 ROOTS | 56 ATTACKS

ONLY THE G-STRING QUALITY NOTE CHANGES: 3 <-> b3

Keep the index, ring, and pinky planted. Add or lift the middle finger on the G string. Use one quarter-note attack per chord; the shape alternates eight times.

F <-> Fm | root fret 1

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|F------Fm-----F------Fm-----F------Fm-----F------Fm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

MOVE G2 <-> G1

G <-> Gm | root fret 3

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|G------Gm-----G------Gm-----G------Gm-----G------Gm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

MOVE G4 <-> G3

A <-> Am | root fret 5

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|A------Am-----A------Am-----A------Am-----A------Am-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

MOVE G6 <-> G5

B <-> Bm | root fret 7

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|B------Bm-----B------Bm-----B------Bm-----B------Bm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

MOVE G8 <-> G7

C <-> Cm | root fret 8

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|C------Cm-----C------Cm-----C------Cm-----C------Cm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

D <-> Dm | root fret 10

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|D------Dm-----D------Dm-----D------Dm-----D------Dm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

MOVE G11 <-> G10

E <-> Em | root fret 12

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|E------Em-----E------Em-----E------Em-----E------Em-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

MOVE G13 <-> G12

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module E - A-shape major/minor quality switches

7 ROOTS | 56 ATTACKS

THE B-STRING 3 MOVES DOWN ONE FRET TO b3; THE HAND REFORMS AROUND THE SAME ROOT

Use the four-string partial shapes first. The major shape uses the D-G-B mini-bar; the minor shape separates the fingers and lowers the B-string note. Alternate eight quarter-note attacks.

B <-> Bm | A-string fret 2

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|B------Bm-----B------Bm-----B------Bm-----B------Bm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

B STRING 4 <-> 3

C <-> Cm | A-string fret 3

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|C------Cm-----C------Cm-----C------Cm-----C------Cm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

B STRING 5 <-> 4

D <-> Dm | A-string fret 5

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|D------Dm-----D------Dm-----D------Dm-----D------Dm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

B STRING 7 <-> 6

E <-> Em | A-string fret 7

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|E------Em-----E------Em-----E------Em-----E------Em-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

B STRING 9 <-> 8

F <-> Fm | A-string fret 8

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|F------Fm-----F------Fm-----F------Fm-----F------Fm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

G <-> Gm | A-string fret 10

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|G------Gm-----G------Gm-----G------Gm-----G------Gm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

B STRING 12 <-> 11

A <-> Am | A-string fret 12

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|A------Am-----A------Am-----A------Am-----A------Am-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

B STRING 14 <-> 13

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module F - same-fret E-shape/A-shape major transfers

6 PAIRS | 48 ATTACKS

THE ROOT FRET STAYS FIXED; THE ROOT STRING AND SHAPE FAMILY CHANGE

G E-shape <-> C A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|G------C------G------C------G------C------G------C------|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 3

A E-shape <-> D A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|A------D------A------D------A------D------A------D------|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 5

B E-shape <-> E A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|B------E------B------E------B------E------B------E------|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 7

C E-shape <-> F A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|C------F------C------F------C------F------C------F------|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 8

D E-shape <-> G A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|D------G------D------G------D------G------D------G------|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 10

E E-shape <-> A A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|E------A------E------A------E------A------E------A------|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 12

Transfer order

Release pressure; keep the index close to the same fret; change the barre range; form the new chord fingers; land from the root-string side; then strum.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module F - same-fret E-shape/A-shape minor transfers

6 PAIRS | 48 ATTACKS

MINOR QUALITY STAYS FIXED WHILE THE ROOT MOVES UP A PERFECT FOURTH

Gm E-shape <-> Cm A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|Gm-----Cm-----Gm-----Cm-----Gm-----Cm-----Gm-----Cm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 3

Am E-shape <-> Dm A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|Am-----Dm-----Am-----Dm-----Am-----Dm-----Am-----Dm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 5

Bm E-shape <-> Em A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|Bm-----Em-----Bm-----Em-----Bm-----Em-----Bm-----Em-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 7

Cm E-shape <-> Fm A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|Cm-----Fm-----Cm-----Fm-----Cm-----Fm-----Cm-----Fm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 8

Dm E-shape <-> Gm A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|Dm-----Gm-----Dm-----Gm-----Dm-----Gm-----Dm-----Gm-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 10

Em E-shape <-> Am A-shape

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------5------6------7------8------|
Chd|Em-----Am-----Em-----Am-----Em-----Am-----Em-----Am-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

ROOT FRET 12

Pressure audit

The index must change from a six-string barre to a five-string barre without remaining fully clamped during the move. A silent release between attacks is correct.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module G - low-E root ladders: E-shape major and minor

2 LADDERS | 28 ATTACKS

ONE CHORD ATTACK PER ROOT; RELEASE BEFORE EVERY SHIFT

Practice in comfort order first: A5, G3, C8, D10, E12, B7, then F1. After the shapes are stable, perform the written fret-order ladder up and down.

E-shape major natural-root ladder

```
Dir|UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----|DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---|
Chd|F------G------A------B------C------D------E------E------D------C------B------A------G------F------|
Fret|1------3------5------7------8------10-----12-----12-----10-----8------7------5------3------1------|
Shp|E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----E-M----|
Atk|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

SPELL F-A-C | G-B-D | A-C#-E | B-D#-F# | C-E-G | D-F#-A | E-G#-B

E-shape minor natural-root ladder

```
Dir|UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----|DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---|
Chd|Fm-----Gm-----Am-----Bm-----Cm-----Dm-----Em-----Em-----Dm-----Cm-----Bm-----Am-----Gm-----Fm-----|
Fret|1------3------5------7------8------10-----12-----12-----10-----8------7------5------3------1------|
Shp|E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----E-m----|
Atk|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

SPELL F-Ab-C | G-Bb-D | A-C-E | B-D-F# | C-Eb-G | D-F-A | E-G-B

RULE One attack, full release, eyes on the destination root, then move. Do not slide a sounding barre.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module G - A-string root ladders: A-shape major and minor

2 LADDERS | 28 ATTACKS

MUTE LOW E; USE THE PARTIAL SHAPE IF THE FULL HIGH-E NOTE FAILS

Practice in comfort order first: D5, E7, C3, F8, G10, A12, then B2. The full and partial versions share the same root, fifth, octave, and quality note.

A-shape major natural-root ladder

```
Dir|UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----|DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---|
Chd|B------C------D------E------F------G------A------A------G------F------E------D------C------B------|
Fret|2------3------5------7------8------10-----12-----12-----10-----8------7------5------3------2------|
Shp|A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----A-M----|
Atk|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

SPELL B-D#-F# | C-E-G | D-F#-A | E-G#-B | F-A-C | G-B-D | A-C#-E

A-shape minor natural-root ladder

```
Dir|UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----UP-----|DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---DOWN---|
Chd|Bm-----Cm-----Dm-----Em-----Fm-----Gm-----Am-----Am-----Gm-----Fm-----Em-----Dm-----Cm-----Bm-----|
Fret|2------3------5------7------8------10-----12-----12-----10-----8------7------5------3------2------|
Shp|A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----A-m----|
Atk|D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------D------|
```

SPELL B-D-F# | C-Eb-G | D-F-A | E-G-B | F-Ab-C | G-Bb-D | A-C-E

AUDIT The low E string remains silent in every chord. If it sounds, correct the index-tip mute before continuing.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module H - same-shape progression routes

4 PROGRESSIONS | 64 ATTACKS

THE SHAPE QUALITY STAYS FIXED; ONLY THE ROOT FRET MOVES

Each progression is four bars with four quarter-note attacks per bar. Speak the destination fret during beat 4. Large shifts are the point of this module.

E-shape major: A-D-E-A

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|A------D------E------A------|
Shp|E5-----E10----E12----E5-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

ROUTE E@5 | E@10 | E@12 | E@5

E-shape minor: Am-Dm-Em-Am

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|Am-----Dm-----Em-----Am-----|
Shp|E5-----E10----E12----E5-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

ROUTE E@5 | E@10 | E@12 | E@5

A-shape major: C-F-G-C

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|C------F------G------C------|
Shp|A3-----A8-----A10----A3-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

ROUTE A@3 | A@8 | A@10 | A@3

A-shape minor: Bm-Em-F#m-Bm

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|Bm-----Em-----F#m----Bm-----|
Shp|A2-----A7-----A9-----A2-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

ROUTE A@2 | A@7 | A@9 | A@2

Shift rule

Release the barre before moving. Look at the destination fret, transport the hand as one unit, land the root-side fingers first, and reapply pressure only after the shape is in place.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module I - mixed-shape major progressions

4 PROGRESSIONS | 64 ATTACKS

USE THE NEAREST E-SHAPE OR A-SHAPE VOICING FOR EACH ROOT

Each progression uses four bars and four quarter-note attacks per bar. These routes reduce the large jumps from Module H and prepare practical movable-chord rhythm parts.

G-C-D-G

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|G------C------D------G------|
Shp|E3-----A3-----A5-----E3-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

SHAPES E@3 | A@3 | A@5 | E@3

A-D-E-A

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|A------D------E------A------|
Shp|E5-----A5-----A7-----E5-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

SHAPES E@5 | A@5 | A@7 | E@5

C-F-G-C

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|C------F------G------C------|
Shp|A3-----E1-----E3-----A3-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

SHAPES A@3 | E@1 | E@3 | A@3

D-G-A-D

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|D------G------A------D------|
Shp|A5-----E3-----E5-----A5-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

SHAPES A@5 | E@3 | E@5 | A@5

Low-fret warning

The C-F-G-C study includes F major at fret 1. Practice it last, use the upper-four partial if needed, and preserve relaxed pressure rather than forcing a full grip.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module I - mixed-shape minor progressions

4 PROGRESSIONS | 64 ATTACKS

THE V CHORD IS MAJOR IN EACH i-iv-V-i ROUTE

The major V chord introduces a strong dominant pull without yet beginning the harmonic-minor scale section. Keep the minor i and iv qualities distinct from the major V.

Am-Dm-E-Am

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|Am-----Dm-----E------Am-----|
Shp|E5-----A5-----A7-----E5-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

SHAPES E@5 | A@5 | A@7 | E@5

Gm-Cm-D-Gm

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|Gm-----Cm-----D------Gm-----|
Shp|E3-----A3-----A5-----E3-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

SHAPES E@3 | A@3 | A@5 | E@3

Bm-Em-F#-Bm

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|Bm-----Em-----F#-----Bm-----|
Shp|E7-----A7-----A9-----E7-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

SHAPES E@7 | A@7 | A@9 | E@7

Dm-Gm-A-Dm

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|Dm-----Gm-----A------Dm-----|
Shp|E10----A10----A12----E10----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

SHAPES E@10 | A@10 | A@12 | E@10

Quality audit

Say minor, minor, major, minor before each pass. If the V chord is accidentally minor, stop and isolate only the quality-changing finger or A-shape reform.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module J - partial-barre rhythm and comping applications

4 STUDIES | 64 ATTACKS

SHORTER VOICINGS REDUCE PRESSURE AND CREATE SPACE FOR ANOTHER INSTRUMENT

J1. Major sustained partials

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|G------C------D------G------|
Shp|E3-----A3-----A5-----E3-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

PATTERN four quarter-note attacks per bar

J2. Minor i-iv-V-i partials

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|Am-----Dm-----E------Am-----|
Shp|E5-----A5-----A7-----E5-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

PATTERN four quarter-note attacks per bar

J3. Clipped A-D-E-A

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|A------D------E------A------|
Shp|E5-----A5-----A7-----E5-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

PATTERN release pressure after every attack

J4. Arpeggiated Gm-Cm-D-Gm

```
Cnt|1------2------3------4------|
Chd|Gm-----Cm-----D------Gm-----|
Shp|E3-----A3-----A5-----E3-----|
Str|D------D------D------D------|
```

PATTERN pick four active strings once per bar

Voicing choice

Use E-shape upper-four partials and A-shape inner-four partials. A partial chord is not a failed full chord; it is an intentional voicing with a smaller attack zone.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Module K - sixteen-bar movable-chord capstones

MAJOR + MINOR | 128 ATTACKS

FOUR QUARTER-NOTE ATTACKS PER BAR; RELEASE PRESSURE DURING EVERY CHANGE

Major capstone - sixteen bars

```
Bars 01-04  | G | C | D | G |
Shapes      | E@3 | A@3 | A@5 | E@3 |

Bars 05-08  | A | D | E | A |
Shapes      | E@5 | A@5 | A@7 | E@5 |

Bars 09-12  | C | F | G | C |
Shapes      | A@3 | E@1 | E@3 | A@3 |

Bars 13-16  | D | G | A | D |
Shapes      | A@5 | E@3 | E@5 | A@5 |
```

Minor capstone - sixteen bars

```
Bars 01-04  | Am | Dm | E | Am |
Shapes      | E@5 | A@5 | A@7 | E@5 |

Bars 05-08  | Gm | Cm | D | Gm |
Shapes      | E@3 | A@3 | A@5 | E@3 |

Bars 09-12  | Bm | Em | F# | Bm |
Shapes      | E@7 | A@7 | A@9 | E@7 |

Bars 13-16  | Dm | Gm | A | Dm |
Shapes      | E@10 | A@10 | A@12 | E@10 |
```

REST RULE Rest at least one full minute between capstone passes; stop earlier if pressure or muting deteriorates.

Guitar Exercises - Section VI, Level 51

Practice progression, error repair, mastery gate, and log

NEXT: MAJOR AND MINOR TRIADS

ADVANCE WHEN THE SHAPE MOVES; DO NOT ADVANCE WHEN THE HAND ONLY SQUEEZES HARDER

Eleven-phase practice progression

1. Root maps and silent calls
2. Pressure fade and release
3. Partial-barre ladder
4. E-shape major family
5. E-shape minor family
6. A-shape major family
7. A-shape minor family
8. Quality and same-fret switches
9. Root ladders
10. Progressions and partial comping
11. Major and minor capstones

Error diagnosis

DEAD BARRED STRING	move index angle or height before squeezing
DEAD CHORD-FINGER STRING	curve the neighboring finger and move closer to fret
LOW E LEAK IN A SHAPE	let index tip touch low E without pressing it
HIGH E DEAD IN A-MAJOR	roll ring mini-barre away from high e
SOUNDING SHIFT	release pressure fully before moving root fret
THUMB FATIGUE	reduce clamp; use arm support and shorter voicing
QUALITY ERROR	isolate G-string or B-string quality note

Mastery gate before Level 52

Find every natural root on low E and A strings; form all four movable families; perform clean low-to-high and high-to-low scans; switch major/minor quality at seven roots; transfer between same-fret E and A families; play all four root ladders; complete the same-shape and mixed-shape progressions; perform both sixteen-bar capstones on two separate days; and finish every session without pain, numbness, or lingering thumb tension.

Completion audit and practice log

- ☐ root maps
- ☐ partial barres
- ☐ E major/minor
- ☐ A major/minor
- ☐ quality switches
- ☐ same-fret pairs
- ☐ root ladders
- ☐ progressions
- ☐ partial comping
- ☐ capstones

Date	Focus	Root/shape	BPM	Clean?	Weak string / movement	Next target